Pyongyang agreed to establish joint military liaison offices in each capital under the supervision of PLA officers.

Initially, it appeared as though China was the nearly unambiguous victor in the Littoral War, but it soon became clear that Beijing's new allies were largely unwilling and resentful partners who felt they had no other choice but to throw in their lot with China. Taiwanese grassroots groups regularly protested against the alliance with China, despite a crackdown authorized by a new public safety law. More ominously, politicians from both the Democratic Progressive and Kuomintang political parties in Taiwan increasingly saw that Xi Jinping intended to formally annex the island before his retirement in 2032, and they began to plot ways to frustrate Beijing's designs.

Even more resistant were the Koreas, which before long began to discuss the formation of a peninsular unity movement that would allow for a united front to deal with China. Anti-Chinese demonstrations regularly took place in major cities throughout the peninsula, and the two Korean capitals soon learned that they could beg out of joint military exercises with the Chinese by claiming lack of funds, unstable public opinion, or (in the South) looming elections.

The third bloc to emerge out of the Littoral War revived the Cold War–era Nonaligned Movement, declaring a comprehensive neutrality between the US and Chinese blocs, opening itself to trade with both, and—depending on the country—allowing mutual military access to both great powers, though in practice this meant far more access for the PLA than for the US military. The nonaligned bloc was centered on the ten members of the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN), headquartered in Jakarta, Indonesia. Some members of ASEAN traditionally had extensive ties with the United States, whether as ally or partner.

While not a formal ally, Singapore nonetheless had had the closest relations with Washington of all Southeast Asian nations prior to the war. In the aftermath, however, Singapore joined its ASEAN partners and moved to distance itself from the United States, announcing that